

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9
♥ A Q 9 3
♦ K 8 7 5
♣ J 6 5

♠ K J 10 8 2

♥ 10 4

♦ 3

♣ Q 10 9 7 2



♠ Q 7 6 4

♥ J 7 2

♦ 9 2

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ 5 3

♥ K 8 6 5

♦ A Q J 10 6 4

♣ K

The bidding has been as shown. It is your turn.

You have 14 points but so what. You have no 5-card suit to Overcall. You cannot make a Takeout Double with 4 of their suit. So you pass. It is important to realize that there are hands you would open but cannot overcall with.

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♦

All Pass

1 ♦ by South

Lead: ♣5

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q J 8 6 4
♥ 4
♦ 10 5
♣ K 10 9 4 2

♠ A 7 5 3
♥ K 10 9 3
♦ K 9 6 4
♣ 5



♠ K
♥ 8 6 2
♦ A 8 3 2
♣ A Q J 7 3

♠ 10 9 2
♥ A Q J 7 5
♦ Q J 7
♣ 8 6

The bidding has been as shown.

With four trumps and 12 points you have a text-book raise to 3♥. Partner had a minimum overcall though, so he passed.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
		1♣	1♥
Pass	3♥		
All Pass			
3♥ by South			
Lead: ♦ 10			

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 6 5 2
♥ 10 6 4
♦ 10 9 2
♣ J 7

♠ A 7 4 3

♥ K 8 3

♦ 6 3

♣ 9 8 4 3



♠ Q J

♥ 9 2

♦ K Q J 4

♣ A K Q 10 2

♠ 10 9

♥ A Q J 7 5

♦ A 8 7 5

♣ 6 5

The bidding has been as shown.

With 12 points and a good suit you have a very solid overcall so you bid 1♥. Partner responds 2♥.

Partner is showing 6-10 points and three trumps. Your hand revalues to 14 at most so you pass.

*West**North**East**South*

1♣

1♥

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by South

Lead: ♣J

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 8 5 4 3 2

♥ Q 7 6

♦ J 3

♣ J 10

♠ 6

♥ K J 9 4 3

♦ K 9 4

♣ 8 7 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A

♥ A 10 5 2

♦ A 10 8 7 5

♣ A K 2

♠ K Q J 9 7

♥ 8

♦ Q 6 2

♣ Q 9 4 3

West

North

East

South

1 ♦

1 ♠

All Pass

1 ♠ by South

Lead: ♦ J

The bidding has been as shown.

You really don't like partner's ♠s, and you do have 8 points. But 8 points is not enough to be considering game, and you would have to bid your ♥s at the 2-level. All things considered it is better to pass while you still aren't doubled.

Board 5

East Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 3
♥ 4
♦ K 9 8 6 4 3
♣ K Q 9 7

♠ J 7 5 2

♥ A 8 6 3

♦ A 10 2

♣ 10 3



♠ A K 8 6 4

♥ 10 9

♦ 5

♣ A J 8 4 2

♠ 10 9

♥ K Q J 7 5 2

♦ Q J 7

♣ 6 5

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by South

Lead: ♣K

The bidding has been as shown.

You overcall 2♥ and hear partner raise you to 3♥.

No matter how many times you check this hand you cannot revalue it any more than 13 points. Since partner has 10 at the most you reluctantly pass.

Board 6

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 10 4
♥ Q 6 5
♦ K J 6 2
♣ J 6 5 4

♠ J 8 3

♥ A J 9 2

♦ 10 7

♣ 9 8 3 2



♠ Q 6 2

♥ 8 7 4

♦ A Q 8 4

♣ A Q 10

♠ A K 9 7 5

♥ K 10 3

♦ 9 5 3

♣ K 7

The bidding has been as shown.

With only 7 points you might not think you have enough to make a "free bid". But in competitive bidding situations like these, where both sides have a fit, bidding is usually better than passing. So you bid 2♠.

You might look at the Law of Total Tricks lesson for more on this subject.

*West**North**East**South*

2♦

2♠

1♦

1♠

All Pass

2♠ by South

Lead: ♠10